

Bandit - Level 05

Goal

The password for the next level is stored in the `inhere` directory tree, in a file that is: human-readable, exactly 1033 bytes, and not executable. 20 subdirectories (`maybehere00` - `maybehere19`), each holding several decoy files.

Connection

```
ssh -p 2220 bandit5@bandit.labs.overthewire.org
```

Use the password retrieved at the end of [Bandit - Level 04](#).

Concepts

The core question this level forces: how do you search *recursively*, across many nested directories, by file properties (type, size, permissions) instead of by name? `find` is built exactly for this — it walks the whole subtree from a starting point automatically. This level was the trigger for giving `find` its own dedicated reference: [Linux - find Command](#).

Attempts Explored

- `du -sh ./` — shows directory sizes, useful for a first look but doesn't single out an individual file or its properties.
- `file ./` — every result came back `directory`. Important realization: `file` **doesn't recurse** — it only reports on the literal items it's given, not on what's inside them. Going one level deeper would mean repeating this by hand for all 20 folders — exactly the "search them all at once" problem that needed a different tool.

Solution

```
find . -type f -size 1033c ! -executable
# → ./maybehere07/.file2

file ./maybehere07/.file2      # ASCII text, with very long lines (1000)
ls -l ./maybehere07/.file2    # 1033 bytes exactly
cat ./maybehere07/.file2      # HWasnPhtq9AVKe0dmk45nxy20cvUa6EG
```

Side discovery: `du -sh` reported `4.0K` for a file that `ls -l` confirms is exactly 1033 bytes. Not a contradiction — `du` measures actual disk space allocated (rounded up to the filesystem's block size, commonly 4KB), while `ls -l` shows the exact logical size of the content. A 1033-byte file still consumes a full 4096-byte block on disk because that's the smallest unit the filesystem allocates.

Key Takeaway

`file` and `find` solve different problems: `file` identifies what one item *is*, `find` locates items matching criteria *anywhere in a subtree*. When the question becomes "search through many nested

folders at once," `find` 's recursion is the default behavior to reach for — no manual looping required. `find` earned a full dedicated reference after this level — worth the investment given how often it resurfaces in security work.

Next

```
ssh -p 2220 bandit6@bandit.labs.overthewire.org
```

 using the password found above.

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